

Effort Reality-Check

Never estimate from the shape of the work. Build the number from tasks and history, then present the corrected figure first.

EVERY TASK, LISTED

From the decomposition worksheet. Estimates on unlisted work are fiction.

THE INVISIBLE WORK

Reviews, revisions, approvals, coordination, cleanup. It is never zero, size each.

THE HISTORY COMPARISON

One comparable past project. What was estimated, what did it actually take?

THE MULTIPLIER AND THE NUMBER

Apply the ratio history shows. Write the defensible total, and the named unknowns if the work is genuinely novel.
